# ShiftCare User Guide

**Version 1.0 — April 2026 Platform:** https://shiftcare-app-rho.vercel.app

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## 1. Getting Started

### Creating Your Account

ShiftCare supports three user types:

| User Type | Who It's For | How to Sign Up |
|---|---|---|
| Healthcare Worker | RNs, LPNs, CNAs, HHAs, Medical Assistants, Companions | Click "I'm Looking for Shifts" |
| Healthcare Employer | Home health agencies, nurse registries, staffing companies | Click "I Need Staff" |
| Private Family | Families hiring caregivers for loved ones | Click "I Need Home Care" |

**Steps to create an account:**

1. Visit https://shiftcare-app-rho.vercel.app/signup
2. Select your role (or use the direct links from the homepage)
3. Enter your full name, email, and password
4. Accept the Terms of Service and Privacy Policy
5. Click "Create Account"
6. Complete onboarding (role-specific — see sections below)

**Google Sign-In:** You can also create an account instantly by clicking "Continue with Google." You'll select your role during onboarding.

**Password Requirements:**

- Minimum 8 characters
- Strength meter shows: Weak / Fair / Good / Strong
- We recommend using letters + numbers + special characters

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## 2. For Healthcare Workers

### 2.1 Completing Your Profile

After creating your account, you'll be guided through onboarding:

**Step 1 — Your Role** Select your healthcare role: RN, LPN, CNA, HHA, Medical Assistant, Companion, or Other. This determines which shifts you'll see.

**Step 2 — Location & Work Area**

- Enter your city and state
- Optionally set your service radius (in miles)
- Add specific cities/areas where you want to work

**Step 3 — Work Preferences**

- Set your weekly availability (per-day time windows)
- Block specific dates (vacations, appointments)

**Step 4 — Credentials & License**

- Enter your license or certification number
- Select your issuing state
- Your credentials enter "Provisional" status immediately — you can start accepting shifts while verification completes (typically 7-14 business days)

## 2.2 Finding & Accepting Shifts

Navigate to **Available Shifts** from the sidebar.

**Browsing Shifts:**

- **Top Picks for You** — personalized recommendations based on your role, location, pay history, and availability
- **List View** — all available shifts in a card grid
- **Map View** — toggle to see shifts plotted on a map with role-colored markers

**Filtering:**

- **Role** — filter by your specific role (RN, CNA, etc.)
- **Pay Range** — set minimum/maximum hourly rate
- **Duration** — filter by shift length (e.g., 4-8 hours, 12-hour shifts)
- **Distance** — filter by miles from your location (5, 10, 25, 50 mi)
- **Search** — search by employer name, location, or keywords
- **Quick Filters** — one-click presets like "$25+/hr" or "8+ hrs"

**Shift Card Information:** Each shift card shows:

- Role badge (color-coded)
- Employer name with rating
- Location with distance from you
- Date and time
- Pay rate and total earnings estimate
- Same Day Pay badge (if enabled by employer)
- Urgency indicator (if starting within 24 hours)
- Pay breakdown: gross amount → 10% service fee → your take-home

**Accepting a Shift:**

1. Click "View & Accept" on any shift card
2. Review the full shift details, requirements, and pay breakdown
3. Click "Accept Shift"
4. You'll see a confirmation screen — the shift appears in "My Shifts"

> ***Note:*** *Only one worker can accept each shift. If someone else accepts it first, you'll see a friendly "This shift was just taken" message with a link to browse similar shifts.*

### 2.3 Managing Your Shifts

Navigate to **My Shifts** from the sidebar.

**Shift Sections:**

- **In Progress** — shifts you're currently working (with clock-out option)
- **Upcoming** — confirmed future shifts (with cancel option)
- **Past** — completed shifts with earnings and rating prompts
- **Cancelled** — cancelled shifts for reference

**Clock-In:**

- A banner appears 15 minutes before your shift starts
- Click "Clock In" — your location is captured for verification
- You'll see ON-SITE or OFF-SITE status based on geofencing

**Clock-Out:**

- After your shift, click "Clock Out" on the green banner
- If clocking out before the scheduled end time, you'll need to provide a reason
- Your actual hours are calculated and shown

**Cancelling a Shift:**

- Click "Cancel Shift" on any upcoming shift
- If cancelling within 4 hours of start time, you'll see a **Late Cancellation Warning**
- Late cancellations add a strike to your record:
  - 1 strike: you see 25% fewer shifts
  - 2 strikes: 50% fewer shifts
  - 3 strikes: account suspended
  - Strikes expire after 90 days of good standing

### 2.4 Earnings & Payouts

Navigate to **Earnings** from the sidebar.

**Dashboard Shows:**

- Pending earnings (awaiting employer confirmation)
- Available earnings (ready for withdrawal)
- Total paid (already withdrawn)
- Monthly earnings chart with trends
- Pace projection: "On pace for $X this month"

**Pay Cadence:**

- **Same Day Pay** — if the employer enabled it, you're paid within hours of shift completion
- **Standard Pay** — earnings released 4 hours after employer confirms completion

**CSV Export:** Click "Export CSV" to download your complete earnings history for tax purposes.

**Documents:** Navigate to **Documents** from the sidebar to view individual shift receipts with full pay breakdowns (gross → fee → net).

### 2.5 Your Profile & Credentials

Navigate to **Profile** from the sidebar.

**Profile includes:**

- Professional info (role, license, certifications, bio, experience)
- Location and service areas
- Rating breakdown (Punctuality, Professionalism, Skill/Competence, Reliability)
- Credential status dashboard showing each credential's verification status and expiry date

**Credential Alerts:**

- You'll receive notifications at 60, 30, 14, 7, and 0 days before your credentials expire
- Expired credentials block you from accepting shifts (same rules as not having credentials)

### 2.6 Schedule & Availability

Navigate to **Schedule** from the sidebar.

- Set per-day availability windows (e.g., Monday 7AM-3PM, Tuesday Off, Wednesday 6PM-11PM)
- Block specific dates with optional reasons
- View a monthly calendar showing your accepted shifts and blocked dates

### 2.7 Notifications & Settings

**Notifications:**

- In-app notifications for shift matches, confirmations, cancellations, payments, credential updates
- Push notifications (enable via the bell button in the navigation)
- Notification frequency: Real-time, Daily Digest, or Urgent Only

**Settings:**

- Change email or password
- Set your timezone (Eastern, Central, Mountain, Pacific, Alaska, Hawaii)
- Manage notification preferences
- Delete account

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## 3. For Healthcare Employers

### 3.1 Completing Your Agency Profile

After creating your account:

**Step 1 — Business Information**

- Company name, phone, description
- Agency type (Home Health, Hospice, Hospital, Nurse Registry, Staffing Company)

**Step 2 — License & Compliance**

- NPI number (required for agencies)
- EIN number
- License number and state
- License expiration date (tracked for renewal alerts)

**Step 3 — Contact & Location**

- Business address, city, state, ZIP
- Contact person name, email, phone

### 3.2 Posting Shifts

Navigate to **Shifts → Post New Shift** from the sidebar.

**Shift Details:**

- Role required (RN, LPN, CNA, HHA, etc.)
- Title (optional)
- Location (with autocomplete)
- Date and start/end times
- Pay rate ($/hr)
- Description and notes
- Requirements (BLS, CPR, Hoyer Lift, Wound Care, etc.)
- Mark as Urgent (prioritized in worker feeds)

**Same Day Pay Toggle:**

- Enable to offer workers immediate payment after completion
- This makes your shift more attractive — workers prioritize same-day pay shifts
- When OFF, standard biweekly payout applies (workers receive payment 4 hours after you confirm completion)

**Invite Preferred Workers First:**

- Toggle to give your preferred workers a 4-hour exclusive window before the shift goes public
- After 4 hours, the shift automatically publishes to all matching workers

**Recurring Shifts:**

- Select multiple days of the week
- Set an end date
- Creates up to 90 shifts at once

**Shift Templates:**

- After posting a shift, click "Save as Template"
- Load templates on the creation form for quick re-posting
- Templates save role, times, location, pay rate, and requirements

### 3.3 Managing Shifts

Navigate to **Shifts** from the sidebar.

**Tabs:** All, Open, Assigned, Completed, Cancelled

**Bulk Actions:**

- Select multiple shifts with checkboxes
- Batch cancel selected shifts
- Duplicate any shift (copies to creation form with pre-filled data)

**Shift Detail Page:** For each shift you can see:

- Assignment status and assigned worker details (name, rating, credentials)
- Time tracking (clock-in/out times with geolocation status)
- Actual vs. scheduled hours comparison
- Payment breakdown

- Shift-specific messaging with the assigned worker
- Completion confirmation (after shift ends)

### 3.4 Managing Workers

Navigate to **Workers** from the sidebar.

**Search & Filter:**

- Search by name
- Filter by role, reliability score, rating

**Preferred Workers:**

- Click the star icon to mark a worker as preferred (requires at least 1 completed shift together)
- Preferred workers get first access to your new shifts via the invite system

**Worker Rating Breakdown:**

- Expand any worker row to see their detailed metrics: Punctuality, Professionalism, Skill/Competence, and Reliability score

### 3.5 Dashboard & Analytics

Navigate to **Dashboard** from the sidebar.

**Key Metrics:**

- Total shifts posted
- Open shifts (awaiting acceptance)
- Filled this month
- Average fill time
- Completed shifts (all time)

**Active Shifts:** Quick view of your current shift assignments

**Shifts Needing Confirmation:** Completed shifts awaiting your confirmation to release payment

### 3.6 Billing & Subscription

**Plans:**

| Feature | Free | Starter ($49/mo) | Professional ($149/mo) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shifts per month | 3 | 25 | Unlimited |
| Worker profile unlocks | 2 | 15 | Unlimited |
| Same-day pay option | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Preferred worker invites | No | Yes | Yes |
| Priority support | No | Yes | Yes |
| Analytics dashboard | No | Basic | Advanced |
| Bulk shift posting | No | Yes | Yes |

**Annual billing** saves 20%: Starter $39/mo, Professional $119/mo.

**No subscription?** You can still use ShiftCare with a 15% per-shift employer fee (charged to you, not workers).

### 3.7 Cancellation Policies

- Cancelling a shift with an assigned worker within 4 hours of start incurs a **$15 late cancellation fee**
- Late cancellations also add a strike to your record (same 3-strike system as workers)
- Provider strikes reduce how many workers see your shifts

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## 4. For Families

### 4.1 Getting Started

Families use the "Private" employer path — simplified for personal care needs.

**Onboarding:**

**Step 1 — About You**

- Your name and phone
- Relationship to patient (parent, spouse, self, etc.)
- Patient's name and age range

**Step 2 — Care Location**

- Street address, city, state, ZIP
- Access instructions for caregivers

**Step 3 — Review & Get Started**

### 4.2 Finding Caregivers

The shift posting process is the same as employers but with role options reordered for home care:

- HHA, CNA, and Companion are listed first
- You can specify care needs in the description

### 4.3 Billing

Families don't need a subscription — you can use the per-shift model (15% employer fee). If you post frequently, the Starter plan ($49/mo) saves money.

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## 5. For Platform Administrators

### 5.1 Admin Dashboard

Navigate to `/admin` (requires admin email in ADMIN_EMAILS env var).

**Platform Stats:**

- Total users, providers, workers
- Active shifts, completed this month
- Pending verifications, open disputes
- Revenue data (subscribers, released shifts)
- Top earners and top-rated users

### 5.2 User Management

- View all users with search and role filter
- Deactivate accounts
- View provider and worker details

### 5.3 Credential Review

- Queue of pending credential submissions
- Approve with expiry date
- Reject with reason (worker is notified)

### 5.4 Dispute Resolution

- View disputed shifts with amounts held
- Release payment to worker
- Refund payment to employer
- Both parties notified of resolution

### 5.5 Provider Verification

- Review pending provider compliance
- Approve or reject with notification

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## 6. Pricing & Billing

### For Workers

**Always free.** A 10% service fee is deducted from your earnings on each shift. You see the exact fee and take-home amount before accepting any shift.

### For Employers

| Option | Cost | Best For |
|---|---|---|
| Pay-per-shift | 15% employer fee per shift | Occasional hiring (< 3 shifts/month) |
| Free plan | $0/mo, 3 shifts/month | Testing the platform |
| Starter | $49/mo ($39 annual) | Regular hiring (up to 25 shifts/month) |
| Professional | $149/mo ($119 annual) | High-volume staffing (unlimited) |

### Break-Even Calculator

If you post more than 4 shifts/month at an average $200/shift, the Starter plan saves money vs. per-shift fees:

- 4 shifts x $200 x 15% = $120/month in per-shift fees
- Starter plan = $49/month
- **Savings: $71/month**

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## 7. Safety & Trust Features

### Credential Verification

- Workers submit licenses and certifications during signup
- Provisional access granted immediately (can accept shifts while verification completes)
- Admin reviews and approves/rejects within 7-14 business days

- Automated expiry tracking with alerts at 60, 30, 14, 7, and 0 days

### 3-Strike Reliability System

- No-shows and late cancellations (within 4 hours of shift start) result in strikes
- 1 strike: 25% visibility reduction
- 2 strikes: 50% visibility reduction
- 3 strikes: account suspended
- Strikes decay after 90 days of clean behavior
- Applies to BOTH workers AND employers

### Multi-Metric Ratings

Workers are rated on: Punctuality, Professionalism, Skill/Competence Employers are rated on: Communication, Work Environment, Payment Reliability, Fairness

### Double-Booking Prevention

Atomic transaction-based shift acceptance ensures only one worker can secure a shift, even with simultaneous accept attempts.

### Geofenced Clock-In/Out

Location is verified at clock-in and clock-out — workers are marked as ON-SITE or OFF-SITE based on proximity to the shift location.

### Provider Cancellation Fee

Employers who cancel shifts with assigned workers within 4 hours of start are charged a $15 fee.

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## 8. FAQ

**How does worker credentialing work?** Workers submit their license and certifications during signup. We verify credentials within 7-14 business days, granting provisional shift access immediately.

**What happens if a worker no-shows?** Our 3-strike system protects employers. After 1 no-show, the worker sees 25% fewer shifts. After 3, their account is suspended. We automatically detect no-shows 30 minutes after shift start and reopen the shift.

**How quickly can I fill a shift?** Most shifts are filled within 30 minutes. Urgent shifts are prioritized in our matching algorithm and sent as push notifications to qualified workers.

**Is there a contract or commitment?** No contracts, no commitments. Cancel your subscription anytime. The free plan never expires.

**How do workers get paid?** Workers choose Same Day Pay (paid within hours) or Standard Pay (released 4 hours after employer confirms). All fees are transparent — workers see exact take-home before accepting.

**Is ShiftCare available outside of Florida?** We're currently serving Florida (Tampa, Orlando, Miami, Jacksonville, St. Petersburg, Fort Lauderdale, Clearwater, Gainesville). Expanding to Georgia, Texas, and California in 2026.

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## 9. Support & Contact

- **Email:** support@shiftcare.com
- **Response time:** Within 24 hours on business days
- **Help Widget:** Click the "?" button on any page for quick links and to send a question
- **Contact Page:** https://shiftcare-app-rho.vercel.app/contact

- **Resources:** https://shiftcare-app-rho.vercel.app/resources